My first step into Product Design! 🚀

I started learning Product Design, and this is my first assignment. I chose Hotstar and looked at it from a user's point of view.

1. 👥 **Who is it for?**

Hotstar is for people who use it for entertainment, like watching movies, web series, TV serials, shows and live sports in their free time.

For example, students who stay in hostels may not have a TV. After college, they may feel tired and want to relax by watching a movie or show. They can simply open Hotstar and watch it.

→ What problem does it solve?
It helps people watch the content they like whenever they want, especially when they don't have a TV or miss something they wanted to watch.

2. 💰 **How does it stay alive?**

🔑 **Subscriptions:**
People may watch their favourite shows regularly for 2 or 3 weeks. When free access ends, they may take a subscription to continue watching.

📺 **Advertisements:**
Brands pay Hotstar to show ads while users watch movies or shows.

🛍️ **Shopping and ordering:**
While watching a video, users may see options like “Order Now” from Swiggy or “Shop the Look”. They can order food or check products while watching. This helps Hotstar earn through brand partnerships and shopping.

3. 📱 **Core UX decisions:**

▶️ **Continue Watching:**
If I stop watching a movie or episode in the middle, I can continue from where I stopped later without searching for it again. It saves time and makes watching more convenient.

🆕 **Newly added content:**
When I open Hotstar, I can see new movies and shows automatically on the home page, so I can easily find something new.

⏭️ **Auto-play:**
After one episode ends, the next episode starts automatically. I don't have to stop and search for the next episode. So, I can continue watching without interruption.

4. 💡 **Things I would change and why?**

🔓 **Free Access:**
After using Hotstar for 2 or 3 weeks, the free access ends. After that, we cannot watch videos without a subscription.

From the business point of view, I feel this is a good decision because people watch their favourite shows daily, and it can become a hobby. So, they may take a subscription to continue watching.

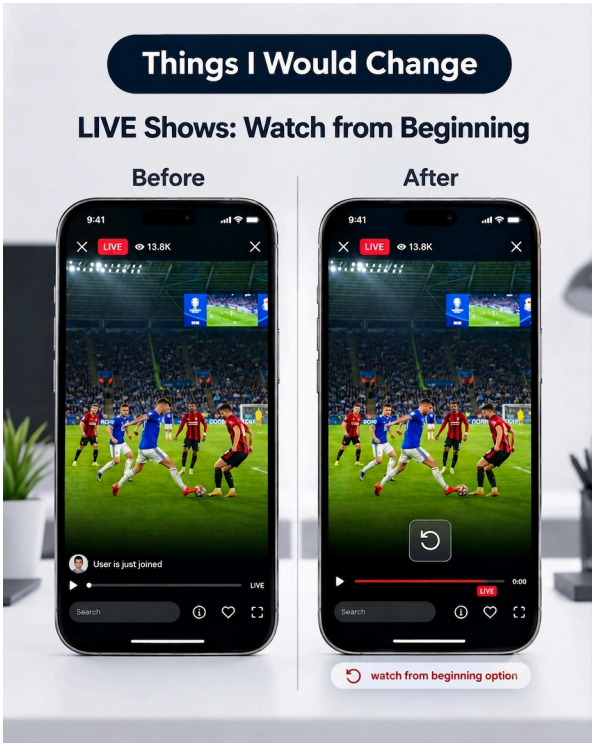
But as a user, it can be disappointing. So, I would keep some shows, movies or older episodes free, while new shows or episodes require a subscription.

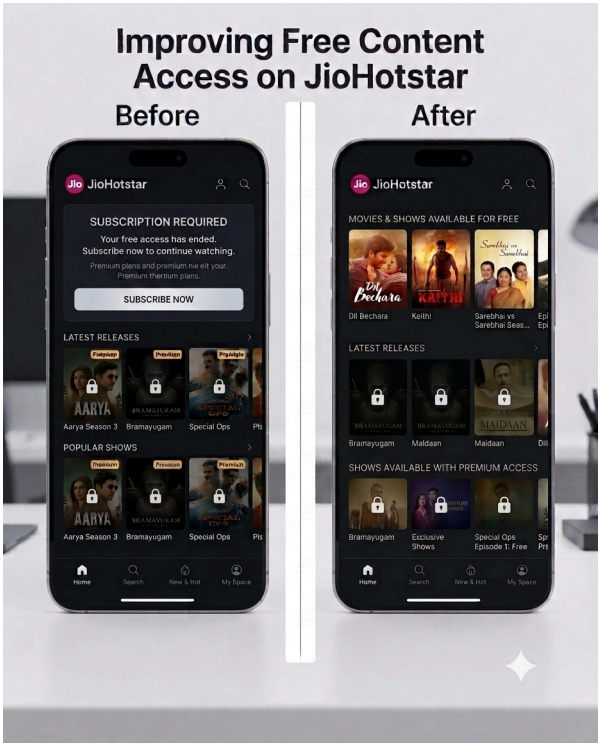
🔴 **Live Video:**
If I join a live show late, I am not able to watch it from the beginning and can go only 10–15 minutes back. I would add “Watch the Live Video from the Beginning” so users can see what they missed.

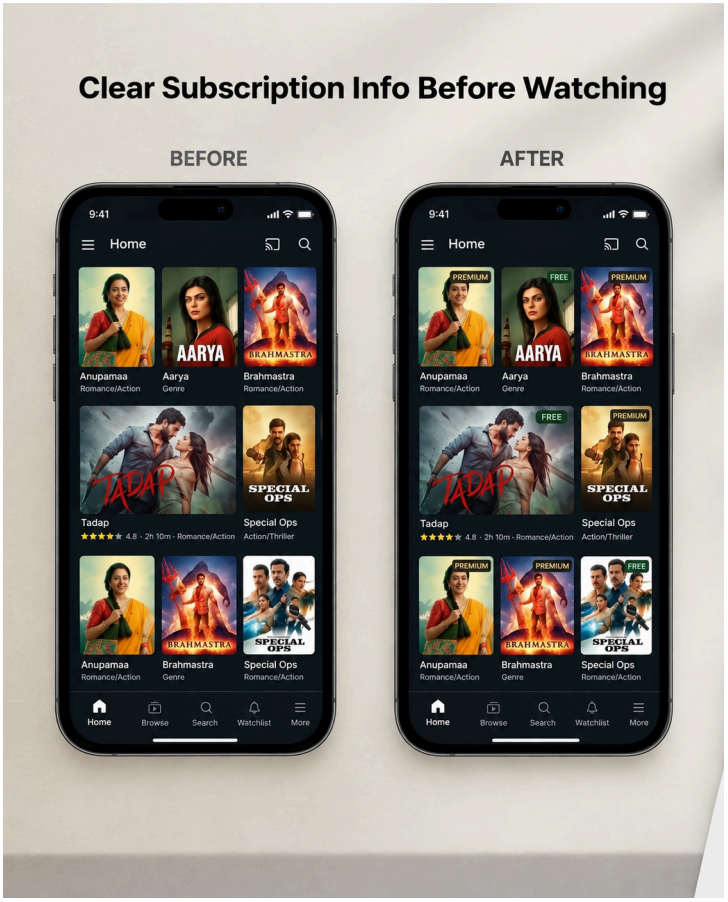
🏷️ **Free or Subscription:**
Before opening a movie or show, it should clearly show whether it is free or needs a subscription. Finding out only after opening the video can be frustrating and disappointing for the user.

5.📚 **What I learned from this assignment**

• While using Hotstar, I understood that a good product should focus on both the business and the user's experience. This assignment helped me look at an app from a user's point of view, identify problems, and think of simple improvements.






Clear Subscription Info Before Watching
BEFORE
AFTER
9:41
Home
Anupamaa
Romance/Action
Aarya
Genre
Brahmastra
Romance/Action
Tadap
4.8 · 2h 10m · Romance/Action
Special Ops
Action/Thriller
Anupamaa
Romance/Action
Brahmastra
Genre
Special Ops
Romance/Action
Home
Browse
Search
Watchlist
More
PREMIUM
FREE